

As I went down to the river to pray

Text: African American Spiritual

Music: African American Spiritual

AS I WENT DOWN TO THE RIVER TO PRAY irregular

The musical score is written for a single melodic line in treble clef, key of D major (one sharp), and 2/2 time. The melody is characterized by a mix of 2/2 and 3/2 measures, creating an irregular feel. The lyrics are written below the notes, with some words hyphenated across measures. Chord symbols (G, D, C) are placed above the staff to indicate harmonic support. The score concludes with a double bar line and the word 'Fine'.

As I went down to the riv-er to pray, stud-y-in' a-bout that good old way,
and who shall wear the star - ry crown, good Lord, show me the way.
1 Oh, sis - ters, let's go down, let's go down, come on down.
Oh, sis - ters, let's go down, down to the riv-er to pray. D.C.

2. Oh, brothers, ...

3. Oh, children, ...

4. Oh, sinners, ...